

USART Serial Communication System

Overview

This project implements a bare-metal Universal Synchronous/Asynchronous Receiver-Transmitter (USART) driver. It is responsible for bridging the STM32 to a PC, providing real-time serial logging of the environmental data captured by the DHT11 sensor.

Objectives

- * Develop a custom USART driver to handle asynchronous serial framing.
- * Automatically calculate and configure Baud Rate mantissa and fraction registers.
- * Implement hardware flag polling (`TXE`) to safely transmit character arrays.
- * Format raw integer data into human-readable text strings using standard C libraries.

Components Used

- * STM32 Nucleo Board (STM32F401RE / F446RE)
- * ST-Link Virtual COM Port
- * PC Serial Terminal (e.g., PuTTY, TeraTerm)

Working Principle

USART relies on an agreed-upon clock speed (baud rate) rather than a shared physical clock line. The driver takes the APB bus frequency and the desired baud rate (9600) to compute the fractional clock divider. Data is loaded into the `USART\_DR` register, framed with a start bit and stop bit, and pushed down the TX line.

System Architecture

- * **GPIO Alternate Functions:** PA2 (TX) and PA3 (RX) mapped to AF7.
- * **Transmission Logic:** A `while` loop that iterates over a null-terminated string, waiting for the Transmit Data Register Empty (`TXE`) flag to go HIGH before sending the next byte.

Implementation Flow

1. Enable USART2 and GPIOA peripheral clocks.
2. Configure PA2 and PA3 to Alternate Function 7 (AF7).
3. Initialize USART2 with 9600 Baud, 8 Data Bits, 1 Stop Bit, and No Parity.
4. Read DHT11 data and format it using `sprintf()`.

5. Call ``USART_Transmit_String()`` to log the data to the PC.

Key Observations

*****Flag Management:***** Attempting to write to the Data Register before ``TXE`` is set results in dropped characters and corrupted strings.

*****Formatting:***** Abstracting the raw data into formatted strings (``"Temp: 32.5 C"``) is critical for debugging and readability.

Results

A highly stable serial connection outputting continuous, easily readable environmental data to the PC monitor without character dropping or buffer overflows.

****Example Output:****

``Temp: 32.5 C``

Key Learnings

* Understanding how fractional baud rate generation translates to physical register configurations.

* Hiding the complexity of ``TXE`` and ``TC`` flag polling inside a clean ``Transmit_String`` API.

 ****Source Code:**** <https://github.com/adlernunez/Adler-Entri/tree/master/ARM%20F401xx/FINAL%20PROJECT/STM32F446RE>

Application Layer (main.c snippet)

```
``c
#include "stm32f401re_usart_driver.h"
#include <stdio.h>
```

```
int main(void) {
    // Initialize USART2 (PA2 TX, PA3 RX)
    usart2_GPIO_PinSetUp();
    USART_Handle_t usart2 = {0};
    usart2.pUSARTx = USART2;
```

```
usart2.USART_Config.USART_Baud = USART_STD_BAUD_9600;  
usart2.USART_Config.USART_Mode = USART_MODE_TX_ONLY;  
usart2.USART_Config.USART_Parity = USART_NO_PARITY;  
usart2.USART_Config.USART_StopBit = USART_STOP_BIT_1;  
usart2.USART_Config.USART_WordLength = USART_WORDLEN_8BITS;  
USART_Init(&usart2);  
USART_PeripheralControl(USART2, ENABLE);
```

```
char display_buffer[32];
```

```
int temp = 32;
```

```
while(1) {  
    sprintf(display_buffer, "Temp: %d C \r\n", temp);  
    USART_Transmit_String(&usart2, display_buffer);  
    delay_ms(2000);  
}  
}
```

DEMO:<https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1eXq7sDkj5dFtnOclj5tX9Nme-Wcqtehi?usp=sharing>